Teach the inquiry, one move at a time

How do choices in different places shape people's lives and our shared world?

Start now: a 15-minute opening

Open **A Better World - Inquiry Journey** and choose **Project this lesson**. Give pairs the one-page **Country Inquiry Starter** or plain paper. The supplied map, survey and headlines are explicitly fictional. No film, online search or teacher-selected source is needed for this opening.

1. Notice (3 minutes) - Point to a map detail; distinguish observation from inference. A bridge is shown; distances, accessibility and bus frequency are not.

2. Compare (4 minutes) - Read the survey. 15 of 20 River Town respondents said yes, compared with 8 of 20 in Hill Town. This does not establish cause or describe everyone.

3. Question media (4 minutes) - Contrast the access and cost headlines. Neither is an outcome. Ask for resident perspectives and transport-service evidence.

4. Choose (4 minutes) - Learners propose an investigable question and one next source. Two real countries can be selected next; practice towns are not country evidence.

Choose pages by the question, not by page order

Governance: 4. Migration: 5. Resources/trade: 6-7. Cooperation/conflict: 8. Rights/fairness: 3. Use evidence and media checks (9-12) across all lenses. Pages 13-14 support explanation and reflection. Page 15 is an optional search menu, not an approved reading list.

Return to real evidence

Model a short source search and check author, purpose, date and evidence. Use specific communities, not stereotypes about whole countries. Every learner investigates both countries. Offer read-aloud, sketches, home-language thinking and oral explanations; do not require family disclosure.

The existing inquiry stays flexible: no new assignment or deadline, no holiday homework and no separate post per page. National Child Day is an optional connection; January sharing remains proposed. Assess reasoning, not agreement or page completion.

COVERAGE MAP • NOT A CHECKLIST OF COMPLETED LEARNING

Plan for curriculum breadth

The map paraphrases the nine content areas in BC Social Studies 6. A focused project will not cover all of them equally. Use the shared lessons and short real-world examples to fill the gaps. [A]

Content area	Booklet entry point	Teaching still needed
Migration and city growth	5; country locator on 2	Pair the fictional family with a real movement or city-growth example.
Poverty and inequality including class and gender	3; perspectives on 12	Include a documented gender barrier and a class/wealth contrast; do not rely on the club example alone.
Individuals public bodies NGOs and Indigenous representative groups	7–8; response plan 13	Identify real organizations and distinguish Nations, governments, representative bodies and NGOs.
Different government systems	4	Compare actual systems, meaningful participation and rights in practice using more than labels.
Economic policy resources and effects on Indigenous peoples	6–7	Study one real policy decision and its documented effects, using a relevant Nation’s account.
Globalization and economic interdependence	6	Trace a verified trade connection and explain mutual reliance or uneven effects.
International cooperation	8; country news 10	Name a real joint response and consider how it works and where it struggles.
Regional and international conflict	8; timeline 12	Use an age-appropriate real case, its causes and consequences, and a peace response.
Media technologies and current events	9–10	Compare coverage; discuss how platforms, framing, ownership or sharing can influence understanding.

This supports the proposed inquiry through January. It does not establish that all Social Studies content has been taught or that Science should begin on a particular date.

STUDENT-LED SEARCHING WITH SUPPORT

Learn by finding sources

Students search, choose and compare sources—not just collect links. Ask what authors intend, which evidence supports claims, where accounts agree or differ, and whose perspectives are missing. Offer starter links, printed excerpts or paired searching when useful, not as prerequisites.

Give every source a usable label

Record code, author, title, date, exact URL or book/page, and data year. Students can cite A1 or B1 in notes. Model an absent date as “not shown,” not today’s date.

Use school search settings and age-appropriate search guidance. No new accounts or personal details are needed. Stop and ask about upsetting content, downloads or unclear claims; offer a supported alternative.

Use the examples accurately

Page 3: B is supported; the difference is 20 percentage points, not proof about happiness or all children. Human rights apply to everyone; children need additional protection. Rights are not earned by behaviour. The UDHR is a declaration; the CRC is a treaty. Ratification does not prove rights are realized: compare commitments, lived experiences and variations within countries.

Page 4: A models democratic participation and accountability; B models concentrated authority. These are simplified invented arrangements, not a full classification system. Monarchy/republic and democracy/authoritarianism describe different features.

Pages 5–6: plausible chains of effects are hypotheses until checked. Students should not infer labour conditions from price alone or every production location from one label.

Page 7: the two source summaries show distinct Indigenous-led relationships with places. They do not establish national outcomes or the views of all Haida, Māori or other Indigenous peoples. Pair this with a specific resource decision and the relevant rights-holder’s own account.

Page 8: consider reliable water information, joint planning, rights, needs and affected communities. Do not reduce an actual conflict to “both sides are equally responsible,” or treat cooperation as automatically fair.

Page 9: F, O, I. Both headlines select part of the same event. A reasonable revision might be “Town tests bike lane as residents discuss safety and deliveries.” Opinion and advocacy can be useful sources when identified and supported.

Participation and care

Offer read-aloud, short excerpts, home-language notes, a visual glossary, scribing, speech-to-text and oral conferences. Preview distressing topics and offer an equivalent alternative. Do not require family disclosure, poverty/refugee simulations or a student to represent a culture.

ASSESSMENT AND NEXT STEPS

Notice the learning

Gather individual evidence during the process as well as from the final presentation. A polished group product does not tell you what each learner understands. Supports do not cap proficiency.

Look for	Useful evidence
A focused question and useful sources	Pages 2, 9–11; student explains why a source helps and what needs checking.
A meaningful comparison	Page 11; same question and comparable measures, precise places and dates.
Perspectives and careful judgment	Pages 7, 12–13; attributed views, differences within a country, reasoned attention to rights and consequences.
Change causes and consequences	Pages 5, 8, 12; dated change or continuity, a plausible explanation distinguished from a proven cause.
An answer and feasible action plan	Pages 13–14; conclusion supported by evidence, honest limit, realistic response and permissions.

Use the proficiency scale thoughtfully

Proficient: explains a supported comparison, uses traceable evidence, considers relevant perspectives and gives a reasoned answer with a next step. This is a proposed task-specific description, not an official Ministry rubric.

Extending: demonstrates deeper or flexible thinking, for example testing an alternative explanation, resolving conflicting evidence or explaining why a solution may need to change in another context. More pages or working without support does not establish Extending.

For Emerging or Developing evidence, identify the particular thinking that needs support and give one reachable next step. Missing evidence calls for a follow-up opportunity, not an automatic judgment about understanding.

Keep existing learning in view

Student Vote and the Indigenous learning already taught remain part of the Social Studies picture. Connect them where the actual evidence fits; do not infer which Indigenous content was covered without checking the lessons. This revised booklet does not require another portfolio post for every page.

Use selected evidence in an inquiry portfolio post when ready. Real-world contact, fundraising and public sharing need separate teacher decisions and school procedures.

REFERENCE LINKS • CHECKED 2 NOVEMBER 2026

Sources and classroom preparation

A BC Social Studies 6

Curriculum planning reference. The content map is paraphrased; sample elaborations are teaching options, not extra mandatory units.

https://curriculum.gov.bc.ca/curriculum/social-studies/6/core

1 UNICEF Children’s rights

Source for the brief rights statement on student page 3. Select education, non-discrimination and participation articles for a shared read.

https://www.unicef.org/child-rights-convention/convention-text-childrens-version

2 Council of the Haida Nation

Haida Gwaii Watchmen. Source of the first page 7 summary. No publication date shown.

https://www.haidanation.ca/hg-watchmen

3 Ngā Tāngata Tiaki o Whanganui

Tupua Te Kawa. Source of the second page 7 summary. No publication date shown. Preserve the source’s names and context.

https://www.ngatangatatiaki.co.nz/our-story/tupua-te-kawa/

UNICEF country profiles

One possible source students can explore with guidance. Check measures, data years and suitability; compare with other sources.

https://data.unicef.org/country/

CBC Kids News

Optional news source; preview before whole-class viewing.

https://www.cbc.ca/kidsnews/

4 UNICEF — What are human rights?

Human rights belong to everyone.

https://www.unicef.org/child-rights-convention/what-are-human-rights

UN Geneva — Human rights

Distinguishes the UDHR declaration from human rights treaties.

https://www.ungeneva.org/en/about/topics/human-rights

Canada — National Child Day

November 20 connection; not an inquiry due date.

https://www.canada.ca/en/public-health/services/national-child-day/celebrate-national-child-day-november-20.html

The fictional cases, headlines and practice numbers in this booklet were written for teaching. They are clearly labelled and must not be cited as evidence about real countries. The student booklet is usable on paper; students can find and compare sources with the support described on page 3.